

DOC 6 • Governance + Engagement System

Project: Public Pulse / Poll Platform Version: v1 Status: Planning Freeze (Implementation Open)

Purpose: Define how content lives, evolves, gets discovered, and stays healthy.

This document does NOT define:

- trust engine
- weighting algorithms
- moderation tooling
- recommendation engine
- social network mechanics

Those are future systems.

This document defines:

Question lifecycle

↓

Discovery

↓

Participation

↓

Visibility

↓

Governance

↓

Return behavior

1. Philosophy

The product should feel:

alive

discoverable

transparent

lightweight

curious

Avoid:

social network behavior

engagement farming

empty gamification

infinite feeds

Participation should emerge because:

questions are interesting

results are rewarding

not because users feel trapped.

2. Governance Principles

G1

Questions are assets.

Questions are not disposable posts.

Lifecycle should be intentional.

G2

Results are historical artifacts.

Even after participation ends:

results may remain.

Visibility and participation are different concepts.

G3

Transparency preferred.

Users should understand:

what happened

why something changed

whether filtering occurred

Trust through visibility.

3. Question Lifecycle

Questions may exist in states:

Draft

↓

Active

↓

Paused

↓

Frozen

↓

Archived

↓

Removed

Definitions:

Draft internal

Active accepting participation

Paused temporarily disabled

Frozen results visible answers closed

Archived historical

Removed exception only

4. Retirement Rules

No universal expiry.

Question decides.

Examples:

Evergreen → remain active

Event → freeze

Tournament → close

Low activity → archive

Default MVP:

keep results visible.

Deletion should be rare.

5. Homepage Governance

Homepage is curated.

Feed sources:

Editorial

Trending

Recent

Explore

Question diversity

No single feed.

Rules:

avoid domination

avoid repetition

surface different categories

Builder decides exact ranking.

6. Discovery System

Discovery should feel:

guided

not algorithmic

Flow:

Question

↓

Result



Related



Explore



Continue

Recommendation sources:

Related

Category

Popular

Random

Question dependent

Randomness allowed.

Purpose: unexpected discovery.

7. Engagement Philosophy

Primary loops:

Answer



See result



See insight

↓

Open next

↓

Share

Avoid:

XP

daily rewards

forced streaks

leaderboards for users

Engagement should emerge from content.

8. Approved Engagement Features

MVP:

Trending

Explore

Share

Question reactions

Result exploration

Optional:

Tournament tracking

Saved questions

Category following

Notifications

Deferred.

9. Community Signals

Approved:

Question Like

Question Dislike

Share

Question URL

Result Image Export

Not approved:

Comment likes

Comment scores

Follow users

Reaction packs

Save systems

Builder may revisit.

10. Comments Policy

Comments are NOT MVP.

Reason:

high moderation cost

low initial value

If implemented later:

keep lightweight

support discussion

never become primary surface

11. Sharing System

Sharing exists in two forms:

Share Link

Download Result

Rules:

No personalized exports.

No custom edits.

Share should preserve:

question

result

context

Output formats: implementation decision.

12. Transparency Rules

Platform should prefer:

visible rules

visible status

visible participation

If filtering exists:

show clearly.

If weighting exists:

show clearly.

Avoid:

hidden manipulation.

13. Governance Visibility

Question may expose:

Status

Participation

Visibility

Result state

Optional:

processing notes

Goal:

users trust process.

14. Builder Challenge Checklist

Builder should ask:

Does this increase participation?

Does this feel social?

Can this be simpler?

Can governance remain visible?

Can engagement emerge naturally?

Challenge all engagement mechanics.

Keep curiosity.

15. Design Agent Instructions

Design owns:

feed structure

homepage

navigation

discovery moments

Respect:

lightweight engagement

question-first model

Final Principle

Questions should spread.

Results should stay.